YUKA

Product Analysis Report

UX Flows · Segmentation · Competitive Analysis · Research Probes

What YUKA Does

A mobile app that allows people to quickly check if a food or cosmetic product is healthy and safe for them by letting them scan the product and providing a score based on multiple factors such as nutritional value, presence of additives, hazardous chemicals, and more.

Part A — Flow Analysis

The following table documents observed UX flows within the YUKA app, the interpretation of each observation, and whether each experience creates a smooth or friction moment for the user.

Flow	What I Observed	My Interpretation	Type
Onboarding	• App installation fast, quick sign up with email/Facebook. Screen prompting customers to start scanning products displayed. Clean look and feel, clear layout	• Standard installation, simple intuitive design is not overwhelming for users	• Smooth
	• No additional questions asked to the user on sign up or soon after logging in.	• Users feel at ease as they don't have to answer questions or fill forms at the start and can dive into using the app	• Smooth
	• Customization for food preferences available (only for Members) on 'recommendation' tab through a small filter icon and limited to few options.Users have to set it up on their own.	• Filter not easily visible. There is a missed opportunity to engage with members (once they upgrade) to get their personal preferences beyond food alerts	• Friction
	• For return users, the first screen shows history of scanned products with a scan button at bottom	• For returning users, showing a list of all past scanned products may not add much value on its own. A screen focused exclusively on scanning ,search would be more beneficial	• Friction
Scanning & Scoring	• Scanning is seamless and health/safety score shown dynamically. Simple plain English words and color-coded icons (red, green) indicate score. On clicking menu icon displayed at top right of product screen,'Scoring method' is displayed along with scientific citations	• The 'score' visuals helps user to make a quick decision if they want to buy the product or not and makes them feel safe when they choose products with green scores . • Transparency in providing their scoring method increases users trust	• Smooth
	• Each scanned product can be opened up to view details. The screen shows a clear image of product at top followed by detailed ingredients list .Description uses common terminologies	• Reduces struggle for users to read complex food/technical labels in small fonts. Eliminates misreading of quantities or missing out key details.	• Smooth

Flow	What I Observed	My Interpretation	Type
	(example: sugar,fibre,protein) instead of scientific names.Positives and negatives summarized per 100g by default .		
	• Sliding bar shows risk levels for each macro/additive/ingredient	• Risk analysis at macro/ingredient level is depicted in a clean, clear way without information overload	• Smooth
	• Scanning and text search (members only) are the only input options	• Some products don't have barcodes. No option to score via picture/screenshot, QR code, voice input, or social media links	• Friction
	• Scanning or text search can be done only per product	• Scanning per product may be time-consuming when users want scores for an entire shopping list.If they shop online,its hard to manually scan items on the list.	• Friction
Recommendations	• Recs screen has a scan button and clicking on it, users can scan a product, get a score, and receive a healthier alternative for poorly scoring products. Text 'No brands pay or partner with YUKA' displayed below recommendations	• Saves users effort from finding alternatives; reduces guesswork and helps them determine quickly if something is a truly a better replacement or not. Declaring to users that their recommendations are independent and they are not associated with any brands, wins users trust	• Smooth
	• Provides Quick comparison score of scanned product vs top recommendation. Separate link to view entire list of recommendations with ingredients breakdown	• Side-by-side scores helps user compare products. Letting users view list only when necessary reduces decision fatigue and keeps screen minimal	• Smooth
	• Alternatives may be in same store, other shops, or only online , no visual indication of availability	• Though they have 'availability' as a key factor while recommending, there is no information to indicate it to user. User may be overwhelmed searching for the product in same store or scanning other brands, while the suggested alternate is available only 'online' or other stores	• Friction
	• Recommendations are per product only	• Users have to manually scan/search for items individually and make a revised shopping list with healthier products • The same would be difficult when users have to scan or swap online shopping cart items	• Friction

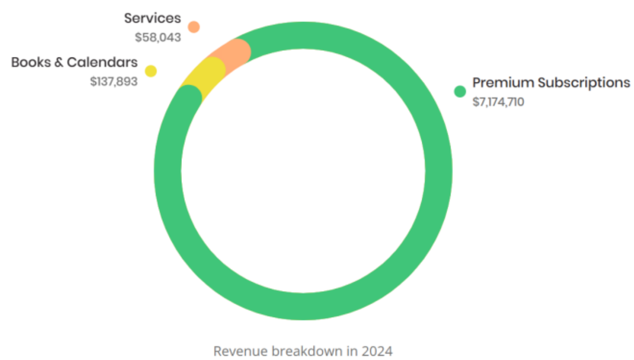
Flow	What I Observed	My Interpretation	Type
	• Physical scanning is the only option	• Ability to describe a product in plain text or upload a screenshot for recommendation is not available	● Friction
Return Visit	• History shows list of all products scanned in past along with score	• Helpful when users come across same products again, but user has to scroll through a long list as search on history is not available	● Friction
	• Only information on scanned products, no history on whether product was purchased or not	• Ability to log a purchase of a scanned product will help users understand if they bought more healthy products overall	● Friction
	• Rating overview dashboard gives overview of scanned products for a month categorized by scores	• Rating overviews would be more beneficial if done on purchased products with more granular breakdown .Weekly Insights emails that can highlight purchase pattern of high calorie products or high sugar products etc can help users modify their choices. That would help them engage with the app long term.	● Friction
	• Personalised,Fair ratings not available and sometimes scores are misleading. Scores are based on presence of ingredients,additives,nutritive value .	• Without considering portion size,user's context, the ratings may not be accurate. Users can abandon purchasing the product. Example: Can of Tuna can be rated as 'poor' due to oil, but might not be 'poor' for some,as its healthy fat and if they consume in less portion.	● Friction
	Ingredient preferences not available for personal care/beauty products	Users don't get alerts for cosmetic products,for ingredients they wish to avoid.They have to go through all the listed ingredients to find that.	● Friction

Competitive Analysis

YUKA competes in the product safety and health scoring space. Below is a summary of how it compares to key alternatives.

Mission

Support users' healthy living by helping them choose safe, healthy products and shaping the market to produce more of such products

Revenue Sources	

Competitor	Key Insights
Open Food Facts	Completely free, open-source food database. Covers a wide range of parameters for food analysis and dives into granular detail ,preferred by users wanting extensive food analysis. **YUKA wins on: Minimal, easy-to-use mobile interface, quick scoring, customisable alerts on food preferences, and healthier alternative suggestions.**
Think Dirty	Wins on: Specifically dedicated to personal care/beauty products; helps users find vetted products quickly, offers novel experiences such as 'Clean Beauty Box'. **YUKA wins on: Premium features from as little as €10, ad-free experience with no brand partnerships, ratings trusted as they are completely independent and science-backed.**
Nutrasafe	Wins on: Focus on UK products with robust UK-based food database,tracks micronutrients,offers conversational AI nutrition coach for members. **YUKA wins on: Broad product coverage (4M food + 2M cosmetic products across US, UK and Europe),unlimited scans in free version,alternative product recommendations.**
NHS Eatwell Guide / Books	Wins on: Educating consumers on overall dietary balance,understanding food labels, front-of-pack colour coding guide. **YUKA wins on: Quickly understanding food labels while shopping, alerts to avoid foods with high-risk additives, instant scoring focused on product at hand.**

Part C — Why It Works

Feature: Scanning

Dimension	Detail
How it works	1. A "Scan" button appears on History tab and Recs tab of the app 2. Users click on it and scan a product 3. Instantly the 'health score' for the product is displayed which indicates the user if a product is safe or not 4. With a quick swipe, the detailed ingredients list along with positives,negatives are displayed in simple english 5.Looking at the score,users can make a decision if they have to buy the product or not
User's Problem	"I want to eat more healthy and use safe cosmetic products but I do not have the time to read and understand food/product labels while shopping . It is challenging to interpret those scientific names ,quantities,hidden chemicals on labels and understand how they impact my health. I feel skeptical about marketing messages on product "
Business Problem	If users have to spend more time for manually searching long list of products and getting a health score after a while ,their user experience suffers and would make them impatient, leading to abandoning the app.
Why it works	**Psychology:** Quick Scan provides confidence to users in their buying decisions within seconds and decreases time spent on reading labels during shopping. It completely removes the guesswork if something they are buying is safe,healthy and of high quality . **Behaviour:** Users who are health conscious,once they see they can effortlessly scan and get a score, they start running their products through the app quickly before their purchase .They start scanning whenever they come across any product of which they are unsure/ if they get doubtful about messages/claims on front of product **Metric:** Number of Scanned products. If there are more products they are scanning,they are engaging with the app and trust the app. They are more likely to share it with friends/family leading to acquisition of new users. Users would be adding more products to database . This ability to cover a broad range of products in turn would help with increasing the user base.

Feature: Food Preferences

Dimension	Detail
How it works	1. On the recommendations tab, a filter is displayed at top 2. Users can click on it and add their preference 3. Food preferences such as palm oil free, Gluten-free,Vegan etc are displayed with checkbox 4. On selecting a few options,those preferences are applied to every search the user does.Users can view alerts below the product scores and they indicate if their preferences are violated or not.
User's Problem	Users following certain diets or with food intolerances are extremely conscious about their food choices.They may be affected by health issues if they consume products violating their food preferences.They feel more disappointed when they are misled by different ingredient names and make a wrong purchase. example : "I have gluten intolerance and high cholesterol .I was advised by my physician to avoid foods that contain more palm oil. Before I buy a product I want to know if they have gluten or used palm oil while making it.I cannot go by marketing messages on product cover and sometimes I feel certain ingredients that I want to avoid are presented with different names at the back label and I dont understand them.”
Business Problem	If users do not get options to set their food preferences,they may be able to view just the details on macro nutrients,presence of additives. Knowing those may not be sufficient for users who have food intolerances or diet restrictions or other health needs .Such users may not return to the app if personalisation according to their diet needs is not available
Why it works	**Psychology:** The ability to personalise those preferences and get highlights of their presence or absence helps them avoid the frustration of buying something they didnt intend to buy. It ensures peace for them by showing the product is safe and healthy not just overall , but to their specific needs **Behaviour:** Once users are able to see those alerts highlighted each time they scan a product ,they get more awareness of hidden ingredients .They start avoiding products that dont work for them with a quick scan before purchase.They are more likely to use those features and continue using the app . **Metric:** Number of users who have converted to members in order to setup food preferences More conversions in order to have the ability personalise the app will generate more revenue

Feature: Search

Dimension	Detail
How it works	1. Search tab provides a text box where users can type the product name or category or brand 2. On typing the name, options to filter product by ratings,type,category,brand are displayed as small dropdowns 3.After product name is typed, filters are chosen if required and user can click on search 4.List of products along with their scores are displayed 5.Clicking on a product from the list ,nutrition details are displayed
User's Problem	Users may always not have barcode for the product or may not always be physically in store to scan a product.Sometimes they want to get a list of best products for a category or a new brand and they do not know if a new product they want to try is safe.Some users may not like scanning products while shopping and would prefer to do a quick search instead **example** : "I want to buy a product online but I dont have the barcode.Also I am not happy with my current product as it has too much chemicals but I am finding it hard to research ,find something that is truly safe for my hair .If I start searching on internet its taking a lot of my time and feels like I am in rabbit hole comparing products .”
Business Problem	Users who dont have barcodes are stuck when they cannot get scores for a product. As they don’t have an option other than scanning,they may not engage with app as much except for when they are in physical stores or when they have the product in hand.There would be times when they want to change a product they are using and want to see good ones available in market . If they cannot search for product using brand names/ product category,we miss those opportunities to connect,help users there
Why it works	**Psychology**: The ability that they can search any product with a simple text makes it very convenient, easy for them and saves them from feeling tired or drained comparing products **Behaviour:** As they can get scores by using a text search, they return to app for quick scans even when they are looking for products online or they come across a new brand . Likelihood of engaging with app is more as this feature can be used beyond physical stores. Some users who do not prefer to be scanning products with their phone cameras, could still get the safety scores using search by text **Metric:** Number of searches by text More ‘search by text’ would indicate users are using this often and as this is available only via membership,this would generate

Dimension	Detail
	revenue through conversions It increases retention as users are able to use the app anytime anywhere to look-up products

Use Cases

- Scanning products while shopping in store
- Checking scores for products at home
- Running quick searches for scores when shopping online
- Finding healthier recommendations
- Discovering and saving new products
- Viewing all products scanned and getting overview of scanned products categorized by scores
- Brands checking for their product listing, scores, and their competitors

Segmentation

The following table outlines the primary user segments for YUKA, their sub-segments, key needs, and the problems they currently face within the app.

Primary Segment	Sub-Segment	Needs	Problems
General Wellness / Health Conscious	Individuals following healthy lifestyle in general	• Interested in Healthy eating, clean personal care products for themselves ,their family.Need to quickly check if a product is healthy (with or without barcodes • Ability to create a Weekly shopping list and get recommendations • Find healthier alternatives	• People have to physically scan products or can search by text (if members). No option for people to voice search or upload product pictures or QR codes and get scores for products that they come across social media (links etc) • Recommendations per product only not for entire shopping list • Alternatives provided considers availability as a factor but doesn't indicate that to user if its available in stores or only online. Users are stuck not being able to find products in stores or online.
	Parents Parents who want to choose healthy products for their kids, use app frequently while shopping for their kids or when they hear about new kids products from friends/online/social media	• Always on lookout for healthy products for their kids , on both food, kids personal care categories • Often shop along with their kids around and may need some predictable products that they know they will be able to get in local stores or online • Access to meal plans,kid meal recipes,easy meal prep ideas based on products recommended • Ability to scan products and get scores for products that they	• Recommendations are not very helpful for some categories (example- sweets,treats) as most of branded,popular products in local stores appear with bad scores .Database does not cover products from small suppliers. • Giving healthier alternates while scanning or while searching is not sufficient as its hit or miss to find the product in local stores or online. • Recommendations are limited to products ,would be time saver for parents if recipe ideas, meal plans can be shared based on products • Scanning or getting score for products from social media (shared via whatsapp groups/facebook/Instagram etc)

Primary Segment	Sub-Segment	Needs	Problems
		come across social media (links etc)	
Users with specific fitness goals	Athletes / Weight Loss May engage more with app when training for specific health goal /event – running a marathon, gaining muscle, reducing weight etc	• Clear and accurate breakdown of calories, a ability to personalise to their nutrient needs Quick Highlights if a products is high on protein or fibre and macro nutrients • Would need to be able to find high quality snack or pre/post workout meal products quickly • Insights on macros,calories of products	• The calorie, macro details are summarized under positives and negatives and feels more generic Personalisation not offered for user goal • No filters available to search food or snack based on macro nutrients. Search is limited to text search by names, brand or category and not descriptive search • Current overview is for scanned products categorized by scores (good,bad,poor etc) and doesn't provide further insights such as calories,macros
Users managing Health Conditions	**Users having diet restrictions and food intolerance** Very sensitive to ingredients in food or cosmetic products and frequently use the app to ensure it doesn't contain anything they want to avoid	• Ability to set specific food preferences and get alerts on ingredients • Searching for ideas on recipes, how to swap products in a generic recipe to suit their diet restrictions • Discovering products that align with their personalised preferences (gluten-free, lactose-free,vegan etc)	• Members can provide food preferences and see highlights on their presence/absence. • Personalised recommendations for diet plans, recipes etc are not available • Members can search for new products by text but results are generic ,doesn't exclude products that do not align with food preferences
	Users with Dermatological / Hair conditions Rely on app to	• People want to understand if product has any allergens or chemicals that	• Beyond quick scores, the details pane lists all ingredients with scientific names and risk levels. The factors are not presented in common terms that are easily understood (such as allergies risk,hairfall inducing etc)

Primary Segment	Sub-Segment	Needs	Problems
	identify ingredients in product that can be harmful to their skin/hair	might aggravate their dermatological conditions or hair care	
	Conscious cosmetic consumers	• Need to ensure they buy 'clean' beauty products	• Not enough information on details pane to determine whether a beauty product is organic, natural, non-toxic, safe, pure, eco-friendly, sustainable, cruelty-free, biodegradable etc
	Users managing lifestyle diseases / recovering from illness	• Need to be able to personalise as per their specific conditions, beyond generic score they need nuanced rating for their context. • Simple workflows to capture context in addition to food preferences and notifying users of those nuances along with scores • When there are changes to scores for products they have scanned before,they need alerts	• Some Products displayed with 'good' scores but lack in alerts for specifics these users care about. No option to set nuanced alerts for health conditions (ex: low cholesterol impact, cancer-free etc) and scores are not accurate as they don't consider the context for users. • Lack of notification when a previously scanned product's score is downgraded .This leads to trust issues and users cannot rely the app for score anymore.
Health Professionals	**Nutritionist/ Clinicians** Use the app for awareness on highly rated products in market **Food and Cosmetic product researchers, Educators**	• Awareness of highly rated products for common health categories • Need to understand if product works for their client and if the score is appropriate for their needs • Need to know Scientific citations that supports scoring of the product , risk	• Search results are limited to broader product categories and doesn't include filtering by health aspects (ex: diabetic friendly or zero fat etc) • Food Scores are misleading as its generic based on ingredients,additives and not specific to patients' specific conditions .Lack of Contextual scoring leads to misinformation to clients • Links to science research papers are available but sometimes outdated

Primary Segment	Sub-Segment	Needs	Problems
		analysis approach	
Business	Restaurants, Cafes, Hospitals, Schools	• Access to scores for products from small suppliers • Ability to upload,scan bulk shopping lists and highlight products that may violate their preferences	• Current database supports crowd sourced products from 'open food fact' database and grows with products scanned by consumers.Ethnic or regional products available are less • Scans or search done individually per product no bulk upload
	Beauty Clinics / Chemists Searching for better products,brands to recommend to their clients	• View details beyond ingredient list: concentration, formulation methods	Scoring does'nt consider concentration,formulation methods used and can score some product as bad/poor due to presence of an ingredient .Details on those aspects not covered in current 'details view'
	Brands Engage with app when they release a new product	• Easy way to add or correct data about their products • Update or correct data about their product • Overview of scores for all their products	• Options available via website but not on app • consumers can report error about a product using 'report' , workflows for brands not available • Insights on scores across all products not displayed

Problem Summary

The table below consolidates all observed problems, the user segments most affected, the confidence level, and the source of the observation.

Observed Problem	Segment	Confidence	Source
User experience when returning to app: Showing a list of all past scanned products or picking up the screen where they left off may be of less value as users return primarily to scan/search products	**All users**	Low	Flow Analysis (Step 1)
Search/Scan Limitations Some products don't have bar codes.Search by text is the other option available but can be done only by brand names/product name or category. A user wanting to get score of a product with the picture/screenshot of product or ingredients list/ qr code/voice input is not possible Products from social media links (whatsapp messages/Instagram or youtube ads) cannot be scored quickly without user manually searching for them Users cannot search for products in descriptive text or by context and get recommendations.	**Members, All users**	**High**	Flow Analysis (Step 1)
Highlight Product Availability: When a product is recommended, it may be available in same store or other local stores or available only online and there is no information to user about availability. User may keep looking for it in same store or keep scanning for more	**All users**	**High**	Flow Analysis (Step 1)

Observed Problem	Segment	Confidence	Source
brands ,while some product is available only ‘online’ or other shops			
Recommendations per product only: Scanning/search done per product. Recommendations for entire shopping list not available. Hard for users to scan items on their weekly shopping list and create a revised shopping list with healthier products. For shopping online,there is no way to scan shopping carts in one go and get swaps for poor score products.	**General Wellness, Parents**	**Medium**	Segmentation needs
History of all scanned products: User has to scroll through long list of scanned items , search on history is not available.	**All users**	**Low**	Flow Analysis (Step 1)
Inconsistent Scores: No notification to user when scores downgrade for products they have scanned before and got ‘good’/’excellent’ ratings previously Users feel less confident to trust the app	**All users**	**High**	Segmentation needs
No visibility to buying behaviour: Summary chart of scanned products categorized by scores is less meaningful. No information on purchase pattern. Generic dashboard less useful for users tracking macros/calories.	**Fitness users (Athletes, Weight Loss)**	**Medium**	Segmentation needs
Missing re-engagement: At the start users get curious to scan products and use the app at high frequency. The usage drops a bit when they have identified list of	**General Wellness, Parents**	**Low**	Segmentation needs

Observed Problem	Segment	Confidence	Source
favorites to go with.They re-engage with the app only when they come across new products or want to compare products Lack of weekly insights or rewards for healthy buying makes it slightly uninteresting for users to stick to habit			
Personalisation for cosmetic/personal care products: No options to set ingredient preferences for cosmetic /personal care product.Makes it difficult for users to find products that violates their preferences as they have to go through entire details pane The details pane uses technical names and risk levels over common terms that are easily understood (such as allergies risk,hairfall inducing etc)	**Dermatology/Hair conditions, Conscious cosmetic consumers**	**High**	Segmentation needs
Lack of personalisation / misleading scores: Scoring/Recommendations does not consider unique user's context,ultra processing etc . They can still score well and may look 'good' in app but include some ingredient they want to reduce or avoid or might not be 'good' for their specific health condition	**Users managing lifestyle diseases, Fitness goal users**	**Medium**	Segmentation needs
Inconsistent Scores No notification to user on change of scores for products they have scanned before . Lack of reasoning behind the change annoys users	**All Users**	**High**	Segmentation needs

Part B — Research Probes

Prioritised hypotheses for further validation, based on flow analysis and segmentation needs.

Priority	Source Problem	Hypothesis	Why Selected	Confidence
P1	**Scan & Search Limitations**	Users struggle to scan products when barcode is not available and text search is limited to members. This leads to despair when they want to scan online products or use other input forms (photos, voice, descriptive, social media links).	Unmet basic need especially with growing online shopping culture. Impacts new customer acquisition.	High
P2	**Product Availability Indication**	**Highlight Product Availability:** When a product is recommended, it may be available in same store or other local stores or available only online and there is no information to user about availability. User may keep looking for it in same store or keep scanning for more brands ,while some product is available only ‘online’ or other shops	Observed directly in flow analysis. Impacts their ability to take action	High
P3	**Trust Gap**	**Trust loss** When users see scores degrade for products they scanned before (which previously had positive scores) and dont get any notifications, their trust in the app’s reliability reduces And not knowing the rationale for	Exposes an inherent flaw in communication of score changes to users Impacts retention and reputation	Medium

Priority	Source Problem	Hypothesis	Why Selected	Confidence
		change adds to their distress		
P4	**Recommendations Per Product Only**	Scanning/text search done only per product. Recommendations for an entire weekly shopping list not available. Hard for users to revise a shopping list with healthier products. Same problem for online shopping carts.	Observed in segmentation needs. High impact for General Wellness users and Parents.	**Medium**